

PHYS 570: Quantum Biology

Lecture 01a

Crash intro to quantum mechanics

De Broglie wavelength
 Time-dependent Schrödinger equation (TDSE)
 Time-independent Schrödinger equation (TISE)
 Free particle, particle in a box, particle in a harmonic potential
 Operators, measurements, expectation values
 Operators, eigenvalues, and eigenfunctions
 Matrix representation of operators and wavefunctions

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Matter: wave-particle duality

Louis de Broglie

1910: Sorbonne, his first degree in history
 1913: degree in science (influenced by his brother)
 1914: military service (World War I)
 1919: continued scientific studies

Idea:

Photon energy is:

$$E = h\nu = hc/\lambda$$

if it is a particle, according to Einstein: $E = mc^2$



$$\lambda = h/mc = h/p$$

→ Extend this idea to other objects, like electrons, with momentum $p=mv$

de Broglie wavelength

$$\lambda = \frac{h}{p} = \frac{h}{mv}$$

Frequency

$$\nu = \frac{E}{h}$$



**Louis Victor Pierre
 Raymond,
 7th Duc de Broglie
 1892-1987**

Note: a more elaborate derivation can be done starting from the group velocity of a wave packet, $v = d\omega/dk$, $h\nu = \text{sqrt}(p^2c^2 + m_0^2c^2)$
 See <https://physics.stackexchange.com/questions/223720/doubt-regarding-de-broglie-relation-from-group-velocity>

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De Broglie wavelength

de Broglie wavelength

$$\lambda = \frac{h}{p} = \frac{h}{mv}$$

Frequency

$$\nu = \frac{E}{h}$$

Particle	Wave
Energy	Frequency
Momentum	Wavelength

Explained Bohr's model of the atom (standing waves)

2024, Thesis « *Recherches sur la Théorie des Quanta* » (Researches on the quantum theory)
(defended at the Faculty of Sciences at Paris University)

(Nobel Prize in 2029)

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Schrödinger: wave equation

Erwin Schrödinger

Oct 1925: Schrödinger read the Einstein paper on the latest developments in atomic physics that mentioned the de Broglie thesis

Presented a colloquium on the de Broglie ideas

Peter Debye's reaction: if matter is a wave, there must be a wave equation!
An equation must exist that describes the motion of a wave!

In a few months, Schrödinger derived the equation that is the foundation of quantum mechanics



Erwin Schrödinger
1887 -1961

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Schrödinger: wave equation

Requirements for the matter wave equation:

1. Consistent with de Broglie-Einstein postulates: $\lambda = \frac{h}{p}$ $\nu = \frac{E}{h}$
2. Consistent with the energy equation: $E = \frac{mv^2}{2} + V(x, t) = \frac{p^2}{2m} + V(x, t)$ $F = -\frac{\partial V}{\partial x}$
3. Must be linear in $\Psi(x, t)$, i.e. if $\Psi_1(x, t)$ and $\Psi_2(x, t)$ are solutions, then any linear combination must be a solution: $\Psi(x, t) = c_1\Psi_1(x, t) + c_2\Psi_2(x, t)$
Required to produce constructive/destructive interference
4. For a constant potential V , the solution must include a sinusoidal traveling wave of constant v and λ
 ↑ i.e., no external forces → constant momentum (wavelength), and energy (frequency)

For the logic behind the derivation of TDSE, see the YouTube Physics Explained lecture:
<https://youtu.be/2WPA1L9uJqo>

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Schrödinger: wave equation

The Schrödinger Equation (1926) (Nobel in 1933)

$$-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{\partial^2 \Psi(x, t)}{\partial x^2} + V(x, t) \Psi(x, t) = i\hbar \frac{\partial \Psi(x, t)}{\partial t}$$

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Wavefunction

But what is the wavefunction $\Psi(x,t)$?

- It is a complex function, but measurement results are real numbers!

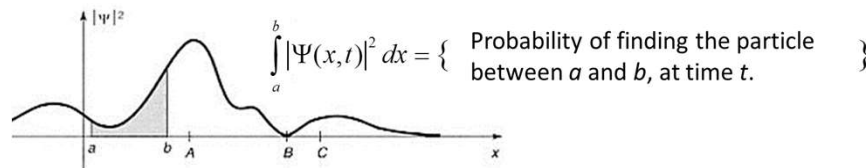
Max Born, 1926 (Nobel 1954):

$|\Psi(x,y)|^2 dx$ represents the probability of finding particle between x and $x+dx$:

$$P(x,t)dx = |\Psi(x,t)|^2 dx = \Psi^*(x,t)\Psi(x,t)dx$$



Max Born
1882-1970



Note: A particle with a definite energy has a definite frequency, so it is spread over infinite space

Note: If a particle has a specific location, it must be represented as a wave packet

→ You cannot predict with certainty the outcome of an experiment

→ Quantum mechanics offers statistical information about possible results

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Solving the Schrödinger Equation: time-independent V

$$i\hbar \frac{\partial \Psi}{\partial t} = -\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{\partial^2 \Psi}{\partial x^2} + V(x)\Psi$$

Separate variables:

$$\Psi(x,t) = \psi(x)\varphi(t) \rightarrow$$

$$\begin{cases} \frac{\partial \Psi(x,t)}{\partial t} = \psi(x) \frac{d}{dt} \varphi(t) \\ \frac{\partial^2 \Psi(x,t)}{\partial x^2} = \frac{d^2 \psi(x)}{dx^2} \varphi(t) \end{cases}$$

$$i\hbar \frac{1}{\varphi} \frac{d\varphi}{dt} = -\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{1}{\psi} \frac{d^2 \psi}{dx^2} + V$$

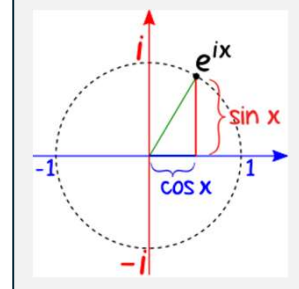
Function of t = Function of x for all x and t → Must be constant!

$$\begin{cases} i\hbar \frac{1}{\varphi} \frac{d\varphi}{dt} = E \longrightarrow \frac{d\varphi}{dt} = -\frac{iE}{\hbar} \varphi \longrightarrow \varphi(t) = e^{-iEt/\hbar} \\ -\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{1}{\psi} \frac{d^2 \psi}{dx^2} + V = E \longrightarrow -\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{d^2 \psi}{dx^2} + V\psi = E\psi \end{cases}$$

**Time-independent
Schrödinger equation**

Euler's formula

$$e^{ix} = \cos(x) + i\sin(x)$$



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Solving the Schrödinger Equation: time-independent V

$$-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{d^2\psi}{dx^2} + V\psi = E\psi$$

$$\varphi(t) = e^{-iEt/\hbar}$$

Solutions: $\Psi(x, t) = \psi(x)\varphi(t) = \psi(x)e^{-iEt/\hbar}$

Note: $\int \Psi^*(x, t) \Psi(x, t) dx = \int \psi^*(x) e^{iEt/\hbar} \psi(x) e^{-iEt/\hbar} dx = \int \psi^*(x) \psi(x) dx$

Or: $\langle \Psi(x, t) | \Psi(x, t) \rangle = \langle \psi(x) | \psi(x) \rangle$ The probability to find a particle at a certain location does not depend on time

We only need to solve for $\psi(x)$: $-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{d^2\psi}{dx^2} + V\psi = E\psi$

We can have more than 1 solution: a set of $\psi_i(x)$ and respective E_i

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Solving the Schrödinger Equation: time-independent V

We only need to solve for $\psi(x)$: $-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{d^2\psi}{dx^2} + V\psi = E\psi$

$$\Psi(x, t) = \psi(x)\varphi(t) = \psi(x)e^{-iEt/\hbar}$$

Can have more than 1 solution: a set of $\psi_i(x)$ and respective E_i

Notes:

- These are *stationary* solutions, the $|\Psi_i(x, t)|^2$ does not change in time
- These are states with *definite* energy
- ψ_i and E_i are *eigenfunctions* (or *eigenstates*) and *eigenvalues* of the time-independent Schrödinger equation
- These states are mutually orthogonal, i.e. $\int \psi_m^*(x) \psi_n(x) dx = \delta_{mn}$
- Any linear combination of these wavefunctions satisfies the Schrödinger equation:

$$\Psi(x, t) = \sum_i c_i \psi_i(x) e^{-iE_i t/\hbar}$$

Expectation energy value $E = \sum_i |c_i|^2 E_i$ But the energy of this state is not definite!
The measurement will return one of the E_i values with the probability $|c_i|^2$

- It is a *complete* set: any solution to SE can be represented by such a linear combination

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Solving the Schrödinger Equation: free particle

Example: Free particle, $V = 0$

$$-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{d^2 \psi}{dx^2} = E \psi \quad \text{Solution: } \psi(x) = A e^{ikx} + B e^{-ikx} \quad E = \frac{\hbar^2 k^2}{2m}$$

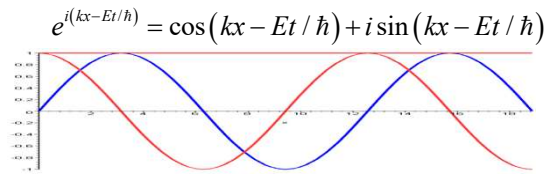
Combine with time-dependent part $\varphi(t) = e^{-iEt/\hbar}$

$$\Psi(x, t) = A e^{i(kx - Et/\hbar)} + B e^{-i(kx - Et/\hbar)}$$

$\rightarrow$ $\leftarrow$
 These are waves traveling in opposite directions,
 combine:

$$\Psi_k(x, t) = A e^{i(kx - Et/\hbar)}$$

$$k \equiv \pm \frac{\sqrt{2mE_k}}{\hbar}, \text{ with } \begin{cases} k > 0 \Rightarrow \text{traveling to the right} \\ k < 0 \Rightarrow \text{traveling to the left} \end{cases}$$



The energy is not quantized and can take any value, continuous spectrum

What is the amplitude A=?

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Particle as a wave packet

Any function can be represented as Fourier series integral

$$f(x) = \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} g(k) e^{ikx} dk = \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} [A(k) \cos(kx) + iB(k) \sin(kx)] dk$$

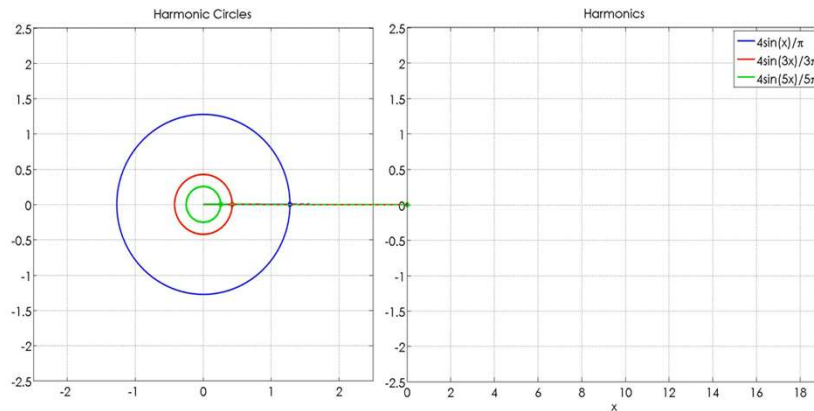
$$\Psi(x, 0) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} \phi(k) e^{ikx} dk$$

$$\Psi(x, t) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}} \int_{-\infty}^{+\infty} \phi(k) e^{i\left(kx - \frac{\hbar k^2}{2m} t\right)} dk$$



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The Fourier series



Create your own: <https://www.geogebra.org/m/aenhzjpz>

Cool visualization: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=r6sGWTMz2k>

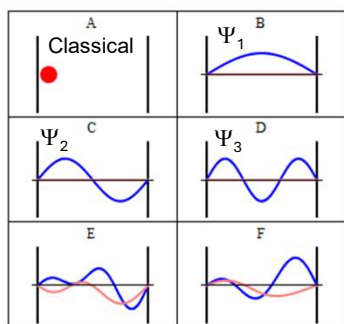
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Particle in a box

Example: particle in a box $-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{d^2\psi}{dx^2} + V\psi = E\psi$

Solutions: $\Psi_n(x, t) = \psi(x)\varphi(t) = \sqrt{\frac{2}{a}} \sin\left(\frac{n\pi}{a}x\right) e^{-iE_n t/\hbar}$ $E_n = n^2 \frac{\pi^2 \hbar^2}{2ma^2}$

Standing waves! Discrete spectrum of energies (energy is quantized)

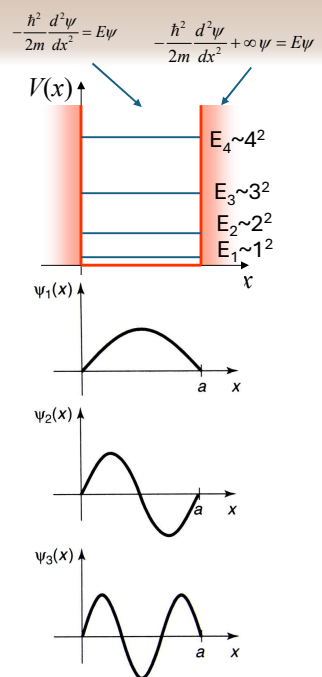


Re(Ψ)
Im(Ψ)

Stationary

Superposition of
 Ψ_1 , Ψ_2 , Ψ_3 and Ψ_4

http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Particle_in_a_box



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Particle in harmonic potential

$$-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{d^2\psi}{dx^2} + \frac{1}{2} m\omega^2 x^2 \psi = E_n \psi$$

Note: any potential function $V(x)$ near minimum can be approximated as $V(x) \sim x^2$ (the first term in Taylor series, $V(x) = c_0 + c_2 x^2 + c_3 x^4 + \dots$)
Spring-mass: $V = kx^2/2 = m\omega^2 x^2 \rightarrow$ Hook's law $\rightarrow F = -dV/dx = -kx$

↓ Hermite polynomials

$$\psi_n(x) = \left(\frac{m\omega}{\pi\hbar}\right)^{1/4} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2^n n!}} H_n(\xi) e^{-\xi^2/2}$$

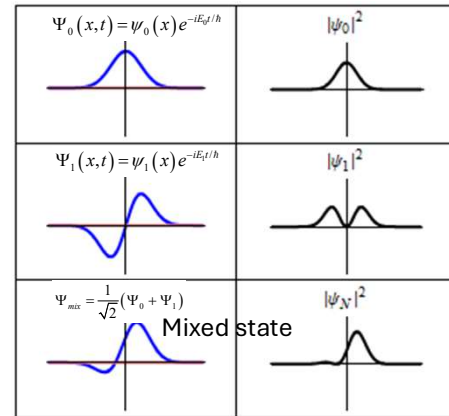
$$\xi \equiv \sqrt{\frac{m\omega}{\hbar}} x$$

(a)

Potential

$H_n(z) = (-1)^n e^{z^2} \frac{d^n}{dz^n} (e^{-z^2})$

$E_n = \hbar\omega(n + 1/2)$
 $n = 0, 1, 2, \dots$
 $\varphi_n(t) = e^{-iE_n t/\hbar}$



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Particle wavepacket in a harmonic potential

Superposition:

$$\Psi(x, t) = \sum_{n=c-2\text{fwhm}}^{c+2\text{fwhm}} c_n \psi_n(x) e^{-iE_n t/\hbar}$$

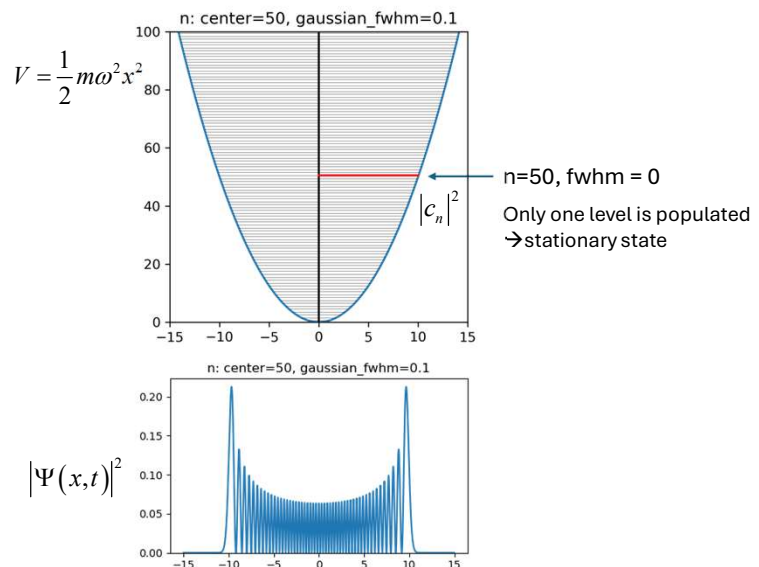
$$E_n = \hbar\omega(n + 1/2)$$

Wavepacket center $n_c = 50$

Expansion coefficients follow a Gaussian distribution:

$$|c_n|^2 = \frac{1}{\sigma\sqrt{2\pi}} \exp\left[-\frac{(n - n_c)^2}{2\sigma^2}\right]$$

$$\text{fwhm} = 2\sqrt{2\ln 2}\sigma$$



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Particle wavepacket in a harmonic potential

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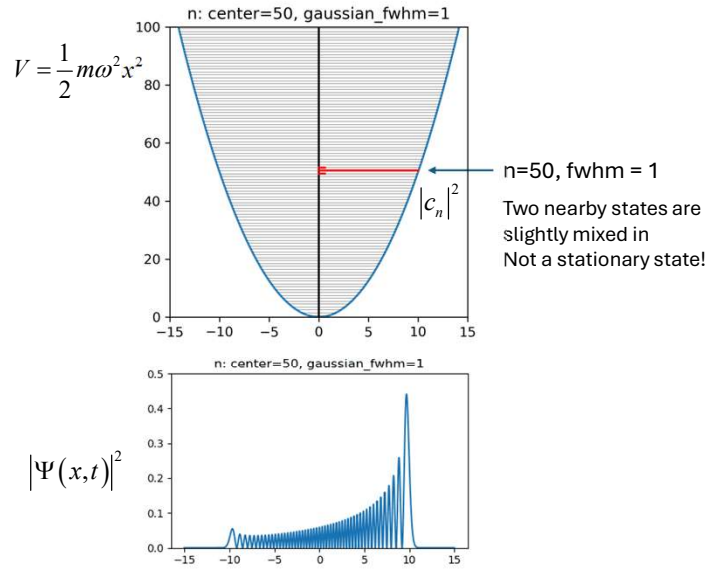
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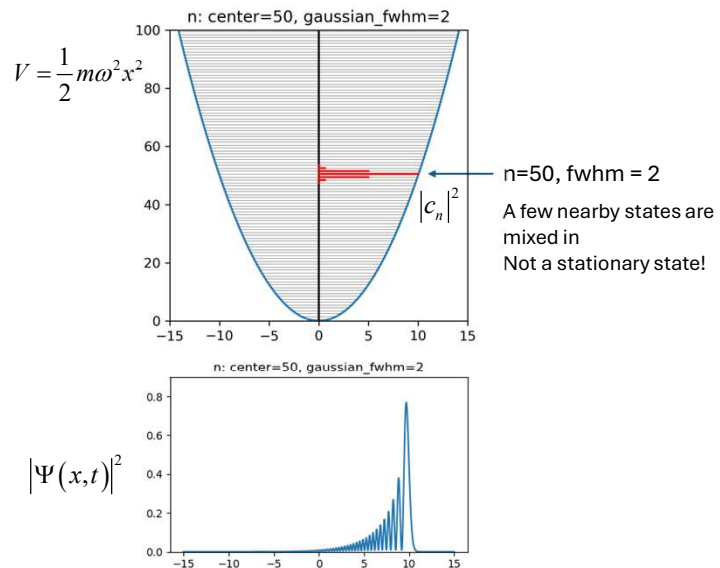
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Particle wavepacket in a harmonic potential

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$$\Psi(x,t) = \sum_{n=c-2whm}^{c+2fwhm} c_n \psi_n(x) e^{-iE_n t/\hbar}$$

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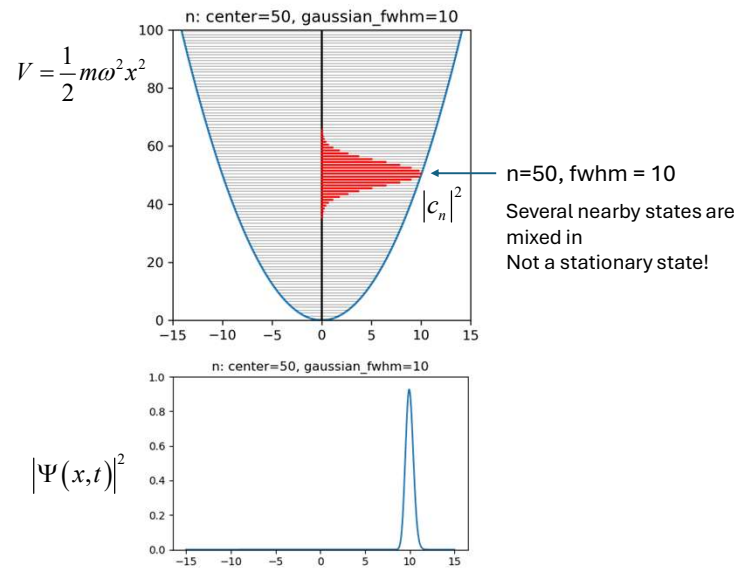
Wavepacket center $n_c = 50$

Expansion coefficients follow a

Gaussian distribution:

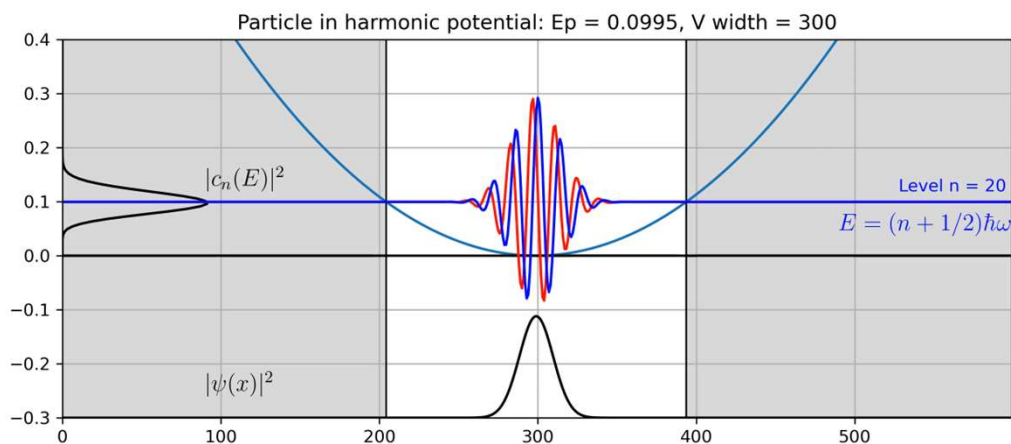
$$|c_n|^2 = \frac{1}{\sigma\sqrt{2\pi}} \exp\left[-\frac{(n-n_c)^2}{2\sigma^2}\right]$$

$$fwhm = 2\sqrt{2\ln 2}\sigma$$



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Particle in harmonic potential



Simulation by S. Savikhin

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Particle wavepacket in a harmonic potential

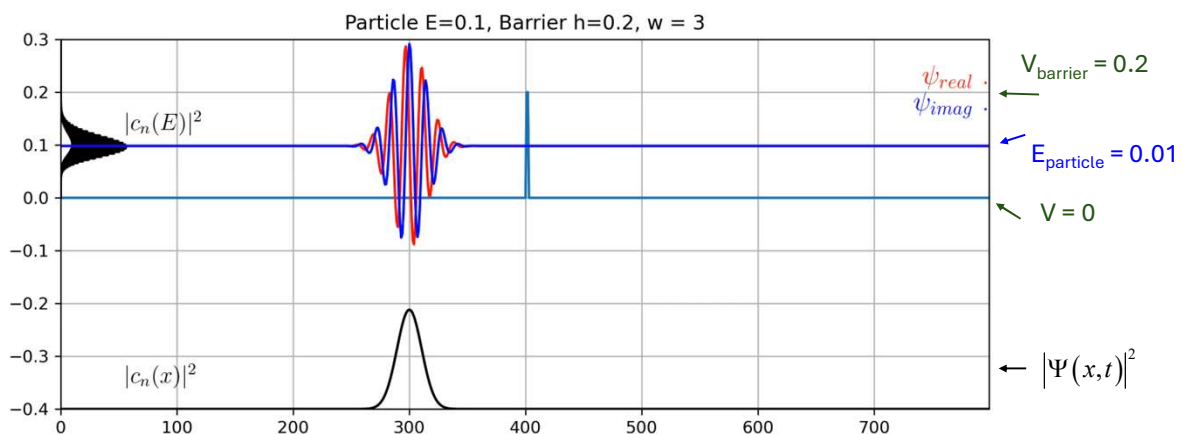
```

1 import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
2 import numpy
3 import math
4 #Choose simple units
5 m=1.
6 w=1.
7 hbar=1.
8 #Discretized space, x-axis
9 dx = 0.005
10 x_lim = 15
11 x = numpy.arange(-x_lim,x_lim,dx)
12 #wavepacket center and width
13 center = 50
14 width = 20
15
16 # service functions
17 def hermite(x, n):
18     xi = numpy.sqrt(m*w/hbar)*x
19     herm_coeffs = numpy.zeros(n+1)
20     herm_coeffs[n] = 1
21     return numpy.polynomial.hermite.hermval(xi, herm_coeffs)
22 def stationary_state(x,n):
23     xi = numpy.sqrt(m*w/hbar)*x
24     prefactor = 1./math.sqrt(2.**n * math.factorial(n)) * (m*w/(numpy.pi*hbar)).**(0.25)
25     psi = prefactor * numpy.exp(- xi**2 / 2) * hermite(x,n)
26     return psi
27 def gauss(pos,center,width):
28     sigma = width/2.35492
29     return 1./sigma/math.sqrt(2*math.pi)*math.exp(-(pos-center)**2/sigma**2/2)
30
31 # make superposition
32 i=1 # output figure file name counter
33 for t in numpy.arange(0,2*math.pi,math.pi/15):
34     wf_re = x*0
35     wf_im = x*0
36     for n in range(center-width*2,center+width*2):
37         phase = (n+0.5)*t # beats between n and n+1 define the period, i.e. it is omega
38         wf_re = wf_re + math.cos(phase)*stationary_state(x,n)*math.sqrt(gauss(n,center,width))
39         wf_im = wf_im + math.sin(phase)*stationary_state(x,n)*math.sqrt(gauss(n,center,width))
40     plt.figure(figsize=(5, 3))
41     plt.ylim(0,1)
42     plt.plot(x,wf_re**2 + wf_im**2) #,Label=f'center={center}, fwhm={width}')
43     plt.title(f'n: center={center}, gaussian_fwhm={width}')
44     plt.savefig(f'fig-c{center:002}-w{width:002}-{i:003}', dpi = 100, facecolor = 'white')
45     i = i + 1

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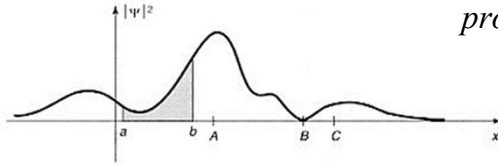
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Quantum mechanical tunneling



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Measurement of a position



$$\text{probability}[a \dots b] = \int_a^b \varphi^*(x) \varphi(x) dx$$

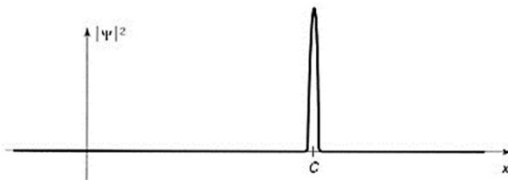
What will be the result of the position measurement?

→ You will get only 1 number, uncertainty in the measurement

Suppose you got c, and then take another measurement on the same particle. What will you get?

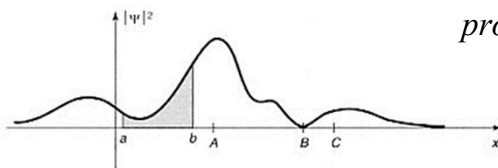
You will get c again!

→ The wavefunction will collapse into a definite position state!



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Measurement and expectation values



$$\text{probability}[a \dots b] = \int_a^b \varphi^*(x) \varphi(x) dx$$

What will be the *average* of many position measurements on a particle with such a wavefunction?

$$\langle x \rangle = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x \cdot P(x) dx = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x \varphi^*(x) \varphi(x) dx = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \varphi^*(x) x \varphi(x) dx$$

Expectation value: $\langle x \rangle = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \varphi^*(x) x \varphi(x) dx \equiv \langle \varphi | x | \varphi \rangle$ ← Dirac's **Bra-ket** notation

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Operators, measurements, and expectation values

Physical quantities are represented by operators:

$$\text{Expectation value: } \langle A \rangle = \langle \Psi | \hat{A} | \Psi \rangle \equiv \int \Psi^* \hat{A} \Psi dr$$

Examples:

$$\langle x \rangle = \int \Psi^* \cdot (x) \cdot \Psi dx$$

$$\langle p \rangle = \int \Psi^* \cdot \left(\frac{\hbar}{i} \frac{\partial}{\partial x} \right) \cdot \Psi dx$$

$$\langle E \rangle = \int \Psi^* \hat{H} \Psi dx$$

Operators:

$$(x) \quad - \text{ position}$$

$$\hat{p}_x = \left(\frac{\hbar}{i} \frac{\partial}{\partial x} \right) - \text{ momentum}$$

$$\hat{H} = -\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{\partial^2}{\partial x^2} + V \quad \text{energy}$$

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Operators, eigenfunctions, and eigenvalues

For any operator, we can find a set of wavefunctions that will produce a definite result in a respective measurement.

Solve the equation:

$$\hat{A}\varphi = A\varphi$$

The solutions are called *eigenfunctions* φ_i and *eigenvalues* A_i of operator $\hat{A}$

Note: operator A acting on the eigenfunction just multiplies it by some constant (eigenvalue)

These solutions are complete, orthogonal and normalized (*orthonormalized*):

$$\langle \varphi_i | \varphi_j \rangle = \delta_{ij}$$

Any other possible wavefunction can be represented as a linear combination of these solutions, or represented in the *basis of eigenfunctions of operator $\hat{A}$*

$$\Psi = \sum_i c_i \varphi_i$$

The same wavefunction can be represented as a superposition of eigenfunctions of a different operator (i.e., using a different set of eigenfunctions), though the expansion coefficients c_i (*eigenvector*) will be different.

$$\langle A \rangle = \langle \varphi | \hat{A} | \varphi \rangle$$

$$\hat{X} = x$$

$$\hat{H} = -\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{d^2}{dx^2} + V$$

$$\hat{p} = -i\hbar \frac{d}{dx}$$

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Vector representation of a wavefunction

Time-Independent Schrödinger Equation (TISE) $-\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{d^2\psi}{dx^2} + V\psi = E\psi$ Or: $\hat{H}\psi_i = E\psi_i$

$$\hat{H} = -\frac{\hbar^2}{2m} \frac{d^2}{dx^2} + V \quad \text{Energy operator (Hamiltonian)}$$

Then any other possible wavefunction can be represented as: $\Psi(x, t) = \sum_i c_i \psi_i(x) e^{-iE_i t/\hbar}$

The expansion coefficients c_i uniquely define this wavefunction *in the basis of eigenfunctions of H*.

Can represent the wavefunction as a vector in the basis of this operator

$$\Psi = \begin{pmatrix} c_1 \\ c_2 \\ c_3 \\ \dots \end{pmatrix} \quad \text{Normalization:} \quad \sum_i |c_i|^2 = 1 \quad \psi_i = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ \dots \\ c_i = 1 \\ \dots \end{pmatrix}$$

Note: the vector components will depend on the choice of the *basis*, i.e., in bases of eigenfunctions of different operators, the coefficients will be different, but they will represent *the same wavefunction!*

This is similar to expressing a geometrical vector in different systems of coordinates.

You can think of the coefficients c_i as of the projections of the wavefunction Ψ to eigenfunctions ψ_i

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Matrix representation of operators

Let (ψ_i, E_i) be the solutions of: $\hat{H}\psi_i = E_i\psi_i$

The Hamiltonian in the basis of its own eigenfunctions can be represented as a diagonal matrix with respective eigenvalues on its diagonal:

$$\mathbf{H} = \begin{pmatrix} E_1 & 0 & 0 & \dots \\ 0 & E_2 & 0 & \dots \\ 0 & 0 & E_3 & \dots \\ \dots & \dots & \dots & \dots \end{pmatrix}$$

$$\Psi = \begin{pmatrix} c_1 \\ c_2 \\ c_3 \\ \dots \end{pmatrix}$$

The expectation value for energy then can be found in the matrix form as:

$$\langle H \rangle = \langle \Psi | \hat{H} | \Psi \rangle = \Psi^T \mathbf{H} \Psi = \begin{pmatrix} c_1^* & c_2^* & c_3^* & \dots \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} E_1 & 0 & 0 & \dots \\ 0 & E_2 & 0 & \dots \\ 0 & 0 & E_3 & \dots \\ \dots & \dots & \dots & \dots \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} c_1 \\ c_2 \\ c_3 \\ \dots \end{pmatrix} = \sum_i |c_i|^2 E_i$$

Note: in the basis of other operator eigenfunctions, the H-matrix will look different.

Note: as long as the wavefunction vector and operator matrix are expressed in the same basis, the $\langle A \rangle = \Psi^T \mathbf{A} \Psi$

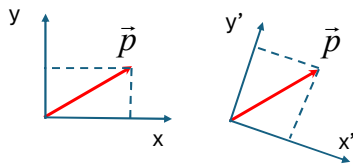
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Vector: projections to basis functions

The wavefunction vector components and operator matrix components depend on the choice of the basis!
In bases of eigenfunctions of different operators, the coefficients will be different, but they will represent *the same wavefunction!*

This is similar to expressing a geometrical vector in different systems of coordinates.

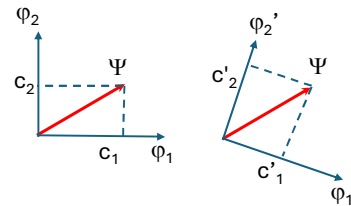
You can think of the coefficients c_i as the projections of the wavefunction Ψ to eigenfunctions ψ_i



$$\vec{p} = x\hat{i} + y\hat{j} = x'\hat{i}' + y'\hat{j}'$$

Projections:

$$\begin{aligned}\vec{p} \cdot \hat{i} &= x\hat{i} \cdot \hat{i} + y\hat{j} \cdot \hat{i} = x \\ \vec{p} \cdot \hat{j} &= y \\ \vec{p} \cdot \hat{i}' &= x' \\ \vec{p} \cdot \hat{j}' &= y'\end{aligned}$$



$$\Psi = c_1\varphi_1 + c_2\varphi_2 = c_1'\varphi_1' + c_2'\varphi_2'$$

$$\langle \Psi | \varphi_1 \rangle = \langle c_1\varphi_1 + c_2\varphi_2 | \varphi_1 \rangle = c_1 \langle \varphi_1 | \varphi_1 \rangle + c_2 \langle \varphi_2 | \varphi_1 \rangle = c_1$$

$$\langle \Psi | \varphi_2 \rangle = \langle c_1\varphi_1 + c_2\varphi_2 | \varphi_2 \rangle = c_1 \langle \varphi_1 | \varphi_2 \rangle + c_2 \langle \varphi_2 | \varphi_2 \rangle = c_2$$

What is the length of this vector?